Emily Zohar

Curriculum Vitae
Toronto, Ontario
emily.zohar@mail.utoronto.ca

Education

PhD in Experimental Psychology — September 2023-Present
University of Toronto, Toronto, ON
Faculty Advisor: Dr. Michael Inzlicht

Bachelor of Science Hon. with Distinction, Psychology — September 2021-April 2023
Queen's University, Kingston, ON
Concentration: Social and Personality
Minor: Mathematics
Faculty Advisor: Dr. Jill Jacobson
Independent Research Project: Convergent and Discriminant Validity of the Jumping-to-Conclusions Fishing Task

Research Experience

PhD Student — September 2023-Present
Work and Play Lab
Faculty Advisor: Dr. Michael Inzlicht
University of Toronto, Toronto, ON

Affiliated Student — May 2025-Present
Bernhardt-Walther Lab
Faculty Advisor: Dr. Dirk B. Walther
University of Toronto, Toronto, ON

Directed Lab Student — September 2022-April 2023
MaSC Lab
Faculty Advisor: Dr. Jill Jacobson
Queen's University, Kingston, ON

Directed Lab Student — September 2022-April 2023
FAB Lab
Faculty Advisor: Dr. Lee Fabrigar
Queen's University, Kingston ON

Publications

Zohar, E., Walther, D. B. (2026). Pretty Useless? Aesthetic Appeal of Office Images Is Associated With Anticipated but Not Objective Productivity. *Journal of Environmental Psychology, 112*, Article 103043. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jenvp.2026.103043

Zohar, E., Bloom, P., & Inzlicht, M. (2026). Against frictionless AI. *Communications Psychology, 4(1)*, Article 39. https://doi.org/10.1038/s44271-026-00402-1

Zohar, E., & Inzlicht, M. (2026). Effort norms encourage more exertion but not less. *Journal of Experimental Psychology. General, 155(4),* 1103–1119. https://doi.org/10.1037/xge0001904

Peetz, J., LeBlanc, C., Wells, T., **Zohar, E.**, & Sidhu, D. M. (2025). On top of the hour: Preference for scheduling and starting tasks at the beginning of the hour. *Canadian Journal of Experimental Psychology/Revue canadienne de psychologie expérimentale, 80(2),* 81–88. https://doi.org/10.1037/cep0000382

Awards and Honours

UTSC Psychology Best Paper Award - Effort norms encourage more exertion but not less
Total amount: $250 2026

CPA Best Article Award in the Canadian Journal of Experimental Psychology (CJEP) / Revue canadienne de psychologie expérimentale (RCPE) 2025

Faculty of Art's and Science Top (FAST) Doctoral Fellowship, UofT 2023-2027
$25,000 per year

Dean's Honour List, Queen's University 2019-2023

Media

Zohar, E., & Inzlicht, M. (2026). Is laziness contagious. *SPSP Character and Context Blog*. https://spsp.org/news/character-and-context-blog/zohar-inzlicht-laziness-effort-contagion

Ramirez, V. B. (2026). What Happens If AI Makes Things Too Easy for Us? *IEEE Spectrum*. https://spectrum.ieee.org/frictionless-ai-psychology

Pereira, M. (2026) Are workers more productive in beautiful spaces? *University of Toronto Faculty of Arts & Science*. https://www.artsci.utoronto.ca/news/are-workers-more-productive-beautiful-spaces

Gupta, S. (2026) AI can take the friction out of life, but some effort can be good. *ScienceNews*. https://www.sciencenews.org/article/ai-removes-friction-effort-balance-good

Conferences and Presentations

Zohar, E., & Inzlicht, M. (2026, April). Effort norms encourage more exertion but not less. Presentation at UTSC Thesis Day.

Zohar, E., & Inzlicht, M. (2025, February). Is There a Limit to Laziness? How Others' Behaviour Impacts Effort Aversion. *Poster presented at the 25th Annual Meeting of the Society for Personality and Social Psychology (SPSP), Denver, CO.*

Zohar, E. & Inzlicht, M. (2024, November). The Downfall of Calendars: The lack of

experimental evidence in support of the effectiveness of digital calendar use. *Presented at the University of Toronto's Social and Personality Research Group meeting*.

Hall, A. D. W., **Zohar, E.,** & Jacobson, J. A. (2024, February). Convergent and discriminant validity of the jumping-to-conclusions fishing task. *Poster presented at the 24th Annual Meeting of the Society for Personality and Social Psychology (SPSP), San Diego, CA*.

Relevant Work Experience

Research Intern
BEworks, Toronto, ON May 2022-May 2023

- Responsible for completing literature reviews for associates on a range of behavioural science topics and research interests.
- Supported BEworks associates and senior strategists on think tanks and client projects.
- Developed a resource on Information Presentation Best Practices for associates to standardize processes and improve associates' productivity. This resource is being considered for productization and commercialization by BEworks.
- Designed and developed MURAL boards, a digital whiteboard, for internal and external workshops.
- Constructed surveys on Qualtrics which were distributed to workshop attendees.

Marketing Intern
Babbly, Toronto, ON June 2020-January 2021

- Createed, managed and published branded content and templates across Babbly's social media platforms.
- Worked closely with Babbly's executive team on the marketing and product plans for the company's app launch, a mobile app that let's parents track their baby's speech development.
- Gained real-world experience working for a company dedicated to optimizing childhood behavioural, linguistic and development psychology.
- Contributed to UX testing and feedback.

Consulting Intern
Consulting Matrix, Toronto, ON Summer 2019

- Conducted market research and competitive analysis for Consulting Matrix's public and private sector clients.
- Designed new presentation templates for use by Principals.
- Designed and coded the company's new modern and responsive website.
- Prepared marketing collateral for client events and meetings.
- Supported Principals in development of marketing strategies.

Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistant
University of Toronto, Toronto, ON

- PSYB10 – Introduction to Social Psychology — Summer 2026
- PSYB70 – Methods in Psychological Science — Fall 2023
- PSYC10 – Judgment and Decision-Making — Fall 2024, Summer 2025, Winter 2026
  - Lecture: The Psychology of Nudges — Fall 2024, Winter 2026
- PSYC71 – Social Psychology Laboratory — Winter 2025
- PSYC13 – Social Cognition: Understanding Ourselves and Others — Winter 2025

Service and Outreach

Co-coordinator — 2025-2026
Social Personality Research Group (SPRG)
University of Toronto, Toronto, ON

- Redesign of the Social and Personality Psychology department website, including a new publications page that auto-populates with department research outputs
- Organizing, and facilitating weekly Social Psychology Department meetings for faculty and graduate students
- Coordinating logistics and hosting responsibilities for invited external speakers and departmental talks

Chief Presiding Officer – Exam Invigilator — 2024-Present
University of Toronto, Toronto, ON

Orientation Coordinator — September 2024-2025
Psychology Graduate Students Association (PGSA)
University of Toronto, Toronto, ON

- Planning events during recruitment and orientation week.

Social Media Coordinator — September 2024-2025
Psychology Graduate Students Association (PGSA)
University of Toronto, Toronto, ON

- Update and redesign PGSA website

Event Coordinator — January 2022-April 2022
Canadian Psychology Association, Queen's University Branch
Queen's University, Toronto, ON

- Responsible for organizing, planning, and running CPA events at Queen's University
- Coordinating and communicating with outreach committee to raise awareness and engagement for CPA and CPA events